

Micah Nelson

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Summary

SANS-trained cybersecurity practitioner with a strong foundation in system security, log and packet analysis, and multi-tool investigation across Windows and Linux environments. Known for analytical clarity, structured documentation, and a genuine curiosity that drives continuous learning through research, training, and hands-on projects. Brings initiative, technical depth, leadership experience, and a thoughtful, problem-solving mindset.

Technical Skills

Security & Analysis: Incident response workflows, log analysis, packet analysis, Windows hardening, Linux hardening, access control & authentication, malware triage, memory forensics, vulnerability analysis, web security, cloud security
Tools & Technologies: Wireshark, Nmap, SIEM (Splunk, ELK), Windows Event Viewer, Sysinternals, Autopsy, FTK Imager
Programming & Automation: Python, Java, C, PowerShell, Bash
Networking & Operating Systems: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, Linux (Ubuntu, Debian, Kali, CentOS), Windows 10/11/XP

Education & Certifications

Northeastern University
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Expected May 2030
Oakland, CA

SANS Cyber Academy

January 2026 – July 2026

GIAC Certifications: Certified Incident Handler (GCIH), Security Essentials (GSEC), Foundational Cybersecurity Technologies (GFACT)

Cyber Projects & Engagement

SANS Cyber Academy

January 2026 – July 2026

- Investigated Windows, Linux, and network-based security events using Sysinternals, Event Viewer, Wireshark, and CLI workflows, improving accuracy in identifying misconfigurations and early indicators of compromise.
- Performed incident-response triage across simulated intrusions, determining scope and attacker behavior to recommend containment actions aligned with SOC playbooks.
- Correlated host artifacts, logs, and packet captures to reconstruct multi-stage intrusion activity and determine adversary progression across the environment.

US Cyber Challenge Cyber Camp

June 2026

- Built Python exploit scripts, practiced buffer overflows, and used Metasploit to exploit vulnerable Windows XP systems, reinforcing fundamentals of basic exploitation techniques and attacker behavior.
- Performed mobile-forensics investigations using Autopsy, iBackUpBot, and SQLite DB Browser to recover deleted artifacts and reconstruct user-activity timelines across multiple scenarios.
- Conducted malware triage and Linux forensics by identifying malicious processes, reviewing password hashes, and detecting an `ld_preload` rootkit in memory using Volatility, improving ability to spot persistence mechanisms.

TryHackMe Cybersecurity Labs

November 2024 – Present

- Completed 150+ hands-on labs across Linux, Windows, networking, web/cloud security, and IR fundamentals, strengthening practical troubleshooting and investigation skills.
- Analyzed packet captures with Wireshark and tcpdump to identify anomalies such as brute-force attempts, suspicious DNS queries, and malformed HTTP traffic, improving detection accuracy.

New Jersey Governor's School of Engineering & Technology Research

July 2024

- Developed a Python-based Binary Ninja plugin with a custom parser and benchmarking logic to automate MBA deobfuscation, reducing manual reverse-engineering time and improving analysis consistency.
- Simplified complex Boolean-arithmetic expressions used in obfuscated binaries, increasing analyst efficiency during malware-analysis and program-analysis workflows.
- Published research through [IEEE Xplore](#) and presented findings at MIT URTC and the NJGSET Symposium, communicating technical concepts to both expert and non-technical audiences.

Leadership & Technical Experience

North Plainfield High School Robotics Team
Captain & Lead Programmer

September 2021 – June 2025
North Plainfield, NJ

- Led development of Java-based robot control systems and collaborated with mechanical and electrical subteams to ensure reliable integration across subsystems.
- Diagnosed system failures under competition deadlines and coordinated rapid fixes, restoring robot performance during high-pressure matches.
- Standardized GitHub repositories and documented programming workflows, improving code reliability, onboarding efficiency, and cross-season continuity.

Somerset Hills YMCA
Administrative Intern

September 2021 – June 2025
Basking Ridge, NJ

- Handled sensitive member data with discretion, ensuring accuracy and confidentiality.
- Built and maintained Excel spreadsheets for attendance, inventory, and communications, strengthening skills in working with structured data.
- Organized program materials and records to keep information consistent and easy to reference.
- Supported daily technical operations by preparing equipment and resolving basic IT issues.